All I Really Need to Know I Learned in Kindergarten - Cinderella

Adapted by Ernest Zulia and David Caldwell
Based on books by Robert Fulghum

*NOTE FROM THE ADAPTERS: **(Pg ix – x)** Originally presented by a 5-person cast. Stories, lines or songs can be reassigned. It is expected that each production will utilize the names of its own cast members in the script.*

This selection adapts to 2 Character presentation (Designated as Actor 1 and Actor 2)
Genders are flexible

ACTOR 1: (Pg 5-6) Share.

ACTOR 2: Play fair.

ACTOR 1: Don't hit people

ACTOR 2: Don't take things that don't belong to you.

ACTOR 1: If you hurt someone, say you're sorry.

ACTOR 2: Hold hands and stick together when you cross the street.

ACTOR 1: Live a balanced life – learn some, think some, work and play.

ACTOR 2: And sing and dance and draw

ACTOR 1: Take a nap each day.

ACTOR 2: (Pg 7) Everything you need to know is in there somewhere.

ACTOR 1: (Pg 8) If we all stopped to take a nap each day, how much better our world would be?

ACTOR 2: And it's still true, when we go out into the world in these uncertain times, it doesn't matter if you're six years old or sixty – we should all hold hands and stick together.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Welcome to Kindergarten!*
ACTOR 2: *Today is an exciting day – it's a day devoted to Fairy Tales.*
ACTOR 1: *And there isn't a better fairy tale than Cinderella!*
ACTOR 2: *(stage whisper) Just remember . . . everything you need to know is in there somewhere*
ACTOR 1: *All I Really Need to Know I Learned in Kindergarten*
ACTOR 2: *Adapted by Ernest Zulia and David Caldwell based on books by Robert Fulghum*

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ACTOR 1: **(Pg 9-15)** Cinderella was the title on the chalkboard marquee.

ACTOR 2: Given the task of dramatizing a fairy tale for a teacher's conference, the kindergarten class decided on the classic old rags-to-riches story, "Cinderella."

ACTOR 1: You know how it goes: "Shy agreeable protagonist, victimized by abusive step-parent, waits for wise matriarchal figure to rescue here, and deliver her transformed from co-dependency to bliss."

ACTOR 2: In other words; if you're good-looking, good at heart and have a fairy godmother . . . you got it made.

ACTOR 1: It was a good choice from the teacher's point of view, because there were so many characters and every child in the class could be in the play.

ACTOR 2: There was the absolutely ravishing Cinderella

ACTOR 1: The evil stepmother.

ACTOR 2: The two wicked but stupid stepsisters

ACTOR 1: The beautiful and wise fairy godmother

ACTOR 2: The pumpkin, mice, coachmen, horses, king

ACTOR 1: All the people at the King's ball

ACTOR 2: And of course, *(strikes a cocky pose)* the Prince.

ACTOR 1: The children were allowed to choose roles for themselves. Finally, every child had a part.

ACTOR 2: Except one. One small boy. Who had remained quiet and disengaged from the selection process. Norman. A kid who was somehow different – not weird, just different – in the way he/she looked at things. Norman was always thinking. And like so many misunderstood, but great thinkers, Norman was teased a lot by his classmates, causing him to live on the fringe of kindergarten society. *(during these lines the actor transforms into Norman a deeply earnest and serious individual)*

ACTOR 1: *(as the teacher)* Well, Norman what are you going to be?

ACTOR 2: *(as Norman)* Well, I am going to be the pig.

ACTOR 1: *(as the teacher)* Pig? There is no pig in the story of Cinderella.

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ACTOR 2: *(as Norman) (after a long pause, matter-of-factly)* Well . . . There is now.

ACTOR 1: Norman did not relate to being a footman or a mouse of a pumpkin.

ACTOR 2: He knew his character. Pig

ACTOR 1: And he intended to participate wherever pigs fit into the scheme of things. Without giving up dignity or identity. He took it for granted that there was a place for pigs, and that the teacher would know that.

ACTOR 2: What do you say to a kid who is already thinking up a costume of pink long underwear, pipe-cleaner tail, and a paper cup for a nose?

ACTOR 1: *(knowing this is the real question)* And what do you say to all the pigs? All those who are different and who do not accept the available boxes and pigeonholes?

ACTOR 2: What did the teacher say? *(teacher is thinking very hard)* Well, sometimes teacher talk more like fairy godmothers!

ACTOR 1: *(as the teacher, waiving her own invisible magic wand)* So be it!

ACTOR 2: And since there was nothing in the script explaining what the pig was supposed to do, the action was left up to Norman.

ACTOR 1: Norman gave himself one of the all-time best walk-on parts in the history of children's theatre.

ACTOR 2: He decided he was Cinderella's "personal pig" *(pause)* Where she went . . . he went.

ACTOR 1: He made no sound. *(Actor 2 as Norman acts out the following narration)* He simply sat on his back haunches and observed. The expressions on his face reflected the details of the dramatic action. Worried *(Norman responds with intense facial expressions for each emotion)* Sad . . . Hopeful . . . Puzzled . . . Mad . . . as the moment required.

ACTOR 2: There was no doubt what was going on, and no doubt that it was important.

ACTOR 1: One look at the pig and you know. The pig was so earnest. So sincere. So very . . . "there."

ACTOR 2: Norman created such dramatic tension that people who knew how this story was supposed to end began to have doubts.

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ACTOR 1: When the Prince finally placed the glass slipper on Cinderella's foot and the ecstatic couple rode off to live happily ever after, Norman ***finally*** made his move. *(Norman explodes into a spontaneous dance of joy with reckless abandon)* He went wild with joy, dancing around the stage on his back feet . . . *(Norman barks wildly, ending with a long howl) (when he stops, pause, then)* . . . and barking like a dog??

ACTOR 1: *(as teacher to Norman)* Even if there was a pig in the Cinderella story, there is no such thing as a dancing, barking pig.

ACTOR 2: *(as Norman – matter-of-factly)* Well, there is now. *(He holds his ground as the teacher contemplates this statement)*

ACTOR 1: *(as teacher) (considers Norman with respect)* It's true, Norman, it's true . . . Knock 'em dead, pig!

ACTOR 2: The presentation at the teachers' conference was a smash hit! *(Pops into the Norman character and dances in slow motion)*

ACTOR 1: When Norman danced his dance, the crowd of weary teachers laughed . . . and wept . . . and cheered *(both actors cheer)* And later when the pig stumbled out for his curtain call. *(Norman crosses for his bow) (both actors start to chant NORMAN . . NORMAN . . . NORMAN)*

ACTOR 2: The teachers were able to see that the real Cinderella was not the little girl with the button nose and blonde hair . . . but Norman, the dancing, barking pig.

ACTOR 1: And they knew the real fairy godmother was not the child waiving her fairy wand, but the teacher, standing weeping in the wings.

ACTOR 2: Kindergarten teachers know magic when they see it.

ACTOR 1: *(as an epilogue)* Well, the kindergarten class had many invitations to perform their highly acclaimed production of "Cinderella."

ACTOR 2: Sometimes the teacher would have to explain what it was about the performance that was so unique.

ACTOR 1: *(as the teacher)* It has a pig in it, you see . . . the star of the show is a dancing, barking pig.

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ACTOR 2: But there is no dancing, barking pig in "Cinderella."

TOGETHER: Well, there is now! *(Both break into Norman's unique dance and end with a bark and howl)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
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